

Kyle Cahitas

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Education

California Polytechnic State University, San Luis Obispo

Master of Science in Environmental Science and Management

San Luis Obispo, Ca

Expected Graduation: June 2026

University of Santa Barbara

Santa Barbara, Ca

Bachelor of Science in Environmental Science

September 2021 - June 2024

University of Waikato

Hamilton, New Zealand

Study Abroad (UCEAP)

July 2023 - Nov 2023

Work Experience

California Strawberry Commission

July 2025 – Dec 2025

GIS Consultant

- Performed geospatial analysis and created maps in ArcGIS Pro to support Life Cycle Assessment of agricultural plastics across three major strawberry-producing counties in California
- Conducted network analysis to calculate transportation distances from strawberry fields to landfills and recycling facilities, providing spatial data for environmental impact assessments
- Interviewed Cal Recycle managers and conducted site visits to recycling centers to gather data and integrate waste management infrastructure into geospatial models for sustainability reporting

California Polytechnic State University, San Luis Obispo

January 2026 – Present

Teaching Assistant – ESCI 502: R Coding Laboratory

- Led coding lab sessions for graduate students, providing technical instruction in R programming for statistical analysis and data visualization in environmental science applications
- Developed troubleshooting skills by assisting students with data management, script debugging, and implementing statistical workflows for research projects
- Communicated complex programming concepts clearly to students with varying technical backgrounds, demonstrating active listening and professional collaboration

Capstone Project: Chatham Islands

July 2023 – Sept 2023

Field Aid

- Coordinated daily field operations for 17-member team and organized geospatial data collection workflows for endemic vegetation surveys across multiple island sites
- Collected and organized documentation of endemic vegetation to collaborate with multiple departments in the University of Waikato and increase awareness of the Chatham Islands
- Conducted comprehensive water quality assessments of five locations throughout the island, concluding that water quality varied on all parts of the island when compared with each site
- Performed spatial analysis of dune erosion using transect data, comparing temporal datasets to identify erosion patterns across three monitoring sites

The Loft Hawaiian Restaurant

Dec 2017 – Dec 2021

Cashier, Server, Manager

- Generated and analyzed financial reports, tracking key performance indicators and identifying areas for improvement
- Directed employee schedules in collaboration with staff members, leading to effective coverage during peak hours and a 50% decrease in mistakes

Skills

Technical: ArcGIS Pro, QGIS, R/RStudio (advanced statistical analysis and data visualization), Python (data analysis, scripting), Microsoft Excel (data queries and organization), GNSS/GPS data collection, mobile data collection platforms

Photography: Proficient in both digital and film cameras, having diverse clients from multiple universities

Software Proficiency: Microsoft Office Word, PowerPoint, Excel, Adobe Creative Suite, and Google Suites